

The Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Five Hundred Lines

Āryapañcaśatikāprajñāpāramitā · Toh 15 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་རོལ་ཏུ་ཕྱི་པ་ལ་བརྒྱ།

Toh 15 in the Kangyur is the Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Five Hundred Lines, known in Sanskrit as the *Āryapañcaśatikāprajñāpāramitā* and in Tibetan as the *Phags pa shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa lnga brgya pa*. It belongs to the Perfection of Wisdom class of *sūtras*, a body of canonical Buddhist scripture that explores the nature of emptiness and the transcendent wisdom cultivated on the bodhisattva path. Like others in this genre, it takes the form of a discourse delivered by the Buddha — here on Vulture Peak Mountain at Rājagṛha — in which he instructs the Venerable Subhūti on the insubstantial nature of the aggregates, sense bases, and all conditioned phenomena. As one of the shorter *Prajñāpāramitā sūtras*, it distills these profound themes concisely, sitting within the broader collection of Perfection of Wisdom texts that forms a central section of the Kangyur.

In the language of India: *Āryapañcaśatikāprajñāpāramitā*. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Five Hundred Lines.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain, together with a great community of monks and a great assembly of bodhisattvas.

Then the Blessed One declared to the Venerable Subhūti: "Subhūti, form is without substance, of base substance, and yet of some substance. Subhūti, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are without substance, of base substance, and yet of some substance. Subhūti, the eye, forms, and eye-consciousness; the ear, sounds, and ear-consciousness; the nose, odors, and nose-consciousness; the tongue, tastes, and tongue-consciousness; the body, tactile objects, and body-consciousness; the mind, phenomena, and mind-consciousness — all of these are without substance, of base substance, and yet of some substance.

"In this way, because ordinary childish persons do not fully know form as it truly and completely is — as set out in these three chapters — they cling to that form, they affirm it, and they obscure themselves with it. Because they

cling to form, affirm it, and obscure themselves with it, they will not attain definite emergence even by way of the vehicle of the śrāvakas or the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas — let alone by way of the Great Vehicle. Clinging to it, affirming it, and obscuring themselves with it in this way, they experience for a long time the aging and death found among hell-beings, animals, hungry ghosts, gods, and humans.

"Subhūti, likewise, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness — being without substance, of base substance, and yet of some substance — and the eye, forms, and eye-consciousness; the ear, sounds, and ear-consciousness; the nose, odors, and nose-consciousness; the tongue, tastes, and tongue-consciousness; the body, tactile objects, and body-consciousness; the mind, phenomena, and mind-consciousness — being without substance, of base substance, and yet of some substance — and thus this mind-consciousness as set out in these three chapters: because ordinary childish persons do not fully know that consciousness as it truly and completely is, they cling to that consciousness, they affirm it, and they obscure themselves with it. Because they cling to that consciousness, affirm it, and obscure themselves with it, they will not attain definite emergence even by way of the vehicle of the śrāvakas or the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas — let alone by way of the Great Vehicle. Clinging to it, affirming it, and obscuring themselves with it in this way, they experience for a long time the aging and death found among hell-beings, animals, hungry ghosts, gods, and humans.

"But the wise ones, fully knowing form as it truly and completely is, as set out in those three chapters, do not cling to it, do not affirm it, but rather illuminate it. Not clinging, not affirming, but illuminating — because of that, they will attain definite emergence even by way of the Great Vehicle; let alone by way of the vehicle of the śrāvakas or the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas."

Not clinging to it, not affirming it, but illuminating it — by so doing, one does not experience aging and death among hell-beings, animals, hungry ghosts, gods, and humans.

"Subhūti, in just the same way, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness; the eye and forms and eye-consciousness; the ear and sounds and ear-consciousness; the nose and odors and nose-consciousness; the tongue and tastes and tongue-consciousness; the body and tangible objects and body-consciousness; the mind and phenomena and mind-consciousness — the wise ones, fully knowing all of these as they truly and completely are, as

set out in those three chapters, do not cling to them, do not affirm them, but rather illuminate them. Not clinging, not affirming, but illuminating — because of that, they will attain definite emergence even by way of the Great Vehicle; let alone by way of the vehicle of the śrāvakas or the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas. Not clinging to them, not affirming them, but illuminating them — by so doing, they do not experience aging and death among hell-beings, animals, hungry ghosts, gods, and humans.

"Subhūti, form arises and disintegrates. That which is the arising of form is itself the non-arising of form. That which is the non-arising of form is the intrinsic nature of form's non-arising. A bodhisattva, a great being, fully knowing as it truly and completely is that intrinsic nature of form's non-arising, thereby authentically establishes the non-arising of form.

"Subhūti, in just the same way, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness arise and pass away. That which is the arising of consciousness is itself the non-arising of consciousness. That which is the non-arising of consciousness is the intrinsic nature of consciousness's non-arising. A bodhisattva, fully knowing as it truly and completely is the intrinsic nature of consciousness's non-arising as it truly and completely is, thereby authentically establishes the non-arising of consciousness.

"Subhūti, if someone says that form is self or belongs to a self — I declare that such a one abides on the side of the childish, ordinary persons who are non-Buddhists; it is a wrong view. Subhūti, if someone says that feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are self or belong to a self — I declare that such a one abides on the side of the childish, ordinary persons who are non-Buddhists; it is a wrong view.

"Subhūti, if someone says that form arises from causes of past deeds, or that it arises from causes created by a lord of creation (Īśvara), or that it arises without any cause or condition — I declare that such a one abides on the side of the childish, ordinary persons who are non-Buddhists; it is a wrong view. Subhūti, if someone says that feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness arise from causes of past deeds, or that they arise from causes created by a lord of creation, or that they arise without any cause or condition — I declare that such a one abides on the side of the childish, ordinary persons who are non-Buddhists; it is a wrong view.

"Moreover, if someone says that form has the defining mark of being material, that feeling has the defining mark of experiencing, that perception has the

defining mark of comprehensively discerning, that formations have the defining mark of active conditioning, and that consciousness has the defining mark of discerning — such a one abides on the side both of non-Buddhists and of childish ordinary persons."

— I declare that such a one holds a wrong view.

"Subhūti, if someone says, 'Form is suffering and is not fully pacified; the cessation of form is happiness and peace' — I declare that such a one abides from the position of the non-Buddhists all the way to wrong view.

"Subhūti, if someone says, 'Feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are suffering and are not fully pacified; the cessation of consciousness is happiness and peace' — I declare that such a one abides from the position of the non-Buddhists all the way to wrong view.

"Subhūti, if someone says, 'Form is simply nonexistent' — I declare that such a one abides on the side both of non-Buddhists and of childish ordinary persons; it is a wrong view.

"Subhūti, if someone says, 'Feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are simply nonexistent' — I declare that such a one abides on the side both of non-Buddhists and of childish ordinary persons; it is a wrong view.

"Subhūti, if someone says, 'All those teachings in which the Blessed One has taught that form is without intrinsic nature, unborn, unceasing, primordially at peace, and by nature fully passed beyond sorrow — all of those teachings are not of interpretable meaning, not of definitive meaning; they are to be understood just as the words literally stand' — I declare that such a one abides on the side both of non-Buddhists and of childish ordinary persons; it is a wrong view.

"Subhūti, if someone says, 'All those teachings in which the Blessed One has taught that feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are without intrinsic nature, unborn, unceasing, primordially at peace, and by nature fully passed beyond sorrow — all of those teachings are not of interpretable meaning, not of definitive meaning; they are to be understood just as the words literally stand' — I declare that such a one abides on the side both of non-Buddhists and of childish ordinary persons; it is a wrong view.

"Subhūti, form does exist — that form in relation to which attachment, arising, and designation occur. Form does exist — that form in relation to which affliction, abiding, and engagement occur. Form does exist — that form in

relation to which purification, attainment, and mastery occur.

"Subhūti, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness do exist — that consciousness in relation to which attachment, arising, and designation occur. Feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness do exist — that consciousness in relation to which affliction, abiding, and engagement occur. Feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness do exist — that consciousness in relation to which purification, attainment, and mastery occur.

"Subhūti, form does exist — that form which, when abandoned and fully known by bodhisattvas and taught, leads to mastery. Subhūti, form does exist — that form which, when abandoned and fully known and correctly taught, leads to mastery. Subhūti, form does exist — that form which, when abandoned and fully known, leads to the possession of virtuous white qualities, to sovereignty over all phenomena, and to abiding in great bliss.

"Subhūti, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness do exist — that which, when abandoned and fully known by bodhisattvas and taught, leads to mastery. Subhūti, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness do exist —"

that consciousness which, when abandoned and fully known and correctly taught, leads to mastery. Subhūti, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness do exist — that which, when abandoned and fully known, leads to the possession of virtuous white qualities, to sovereignty over all phenomena, and to abiding in great bliss.

Subhūti, whatever bodhisattva does not correctly discern form as merely form and merely suffering — that one apprehends a self in form. Whoever apprehends a self in form apprehends the view of a self in form. Whoever apprehends the view of a self in form apprehends everything in form. Whoever apprehends everything in form does not apprehend everything in form. When one apprehends everything in form yet does not apprehend everything — that apprehension is thoroughly established. If one abides in that apprehension, one will not find definitive liberation even through the vehicle of the śrāvakas or the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, let alone through the Great Vehicle — what need is there to say anything about that?

Subhūti, whatever bodhisattva does not correctly discern feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as merely consciousness and merely suffering — that one apprehends a self in consciousness. Whoever apprehends a self in consciousness apprehends the view of a self in consciousness. Whoever

apprehends the view of a self in consciousness apprehends everything in consciousness. Whoever apprehends everything in consciousness does not apprehend everything in consciousness. When one apprehends everything in consciousness yet does not apprehend everything — that apprehension is thoroughly established. If one abides in that apprehension, one will not find definitive liberation even through the vehicle of the śrāvakas or the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, let alone through the Great Vehicle — what need is there to say anything about that?

Subhūti, whoever correctly discerns form as merely form and merely suffering does not apprehend a self in form. Whoever does not apprehend a self in form does not apprehend the view of a self in form. Whoever does not apprehend the view of a self in form does not apprehend everything in form. Whoever does not apprehend everything in form does apprehend everything in form. When one does not apprehend everything in form yet does apprehend everything — that apprehension is thoroughly established. If one abides in that apprehension, one will find definitive liberation through the vehicle of the śrāvakas and the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, but not through the Great Vehicle.

Subhūti, whoever correctly discerns feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as merely consciousness and merely suffering does not apprehend a self in consciousness. Whoever does not apprehend a self in consciousness does not apprehend the view of a self in consciousness. Whoever does not apprehend the view of a self in consciousness does not apprehend everything in consciousness. Whoever does not apprehend everything in consciousness does apprehend everything in consciousness. When one does not apprehend everything in consciousness yet does apprehend everything — that apprehension is thoroughly established. If one abides in that non-apprehension, one will find definitive liberation through the vehicle of the śrāvakas and the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, but not through the Great Vehicle.

Subhūti, whoever does not correctly discern form as merely what is imputed — merely superimposed and not truly real — and merely as confusion, that one apprehends form as form. Whoever apprehends form as form apprehends the view of form as form. Whoever apprehends the view of form as form apprehends everything in form.

Whoever apprehends everything in form does not apprehend everything in form. When one apprehends everything in form yet does not apprehend everything — that apprehension is thoroughly established. If one abides in that apprehension, one will find definitive liberation neither through the vehicle of the śrāvakas nor through the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, let alone through the Great Vehicle — what need is there to speak of it?

Subhūti, whoever does not correctly discern feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as merely what is imputed — merely superimposed and not truly real — and merely as confusion, that one apprehends consciousness as consciousness. Whoever apprehends consciousness as consciousness apprehends the view of consciousness as consciousness. Whoever apprehends the view of consciousness as consciousness apprehends everything in consciousness. Whoever apprehends everything in consciousness does not apprehend everything in consciousness. When one apprehends everything in consciousness yet does not apprehend everything — that apprehension is thoroughly established. If one abides in that apprehension, one will find definitive liberation neither through the vehicle of the śrāvakas nor through the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas — what need is there to speak of the Great Vehicle?

Subhūti, whoever correctly discerns form as merely what is imputed — merely superimposed and not truly real — and merely as confusion, that one does not apprehend form as form. Whoever does not apprehend form as form does not apprehend the view of form as form. Whoever does not apprehend the view of form as form does not apprehend everything in form. Whoever does not apprehend everything in form does not apprehend everything in form. When one does not apprehend everything in form yet does apprehend everything — that apprehension is thoroughly established. If one abides in that non-apprehension, one will find definitive liberation even through the Great Vehicle — what need is there to speak of the vehicle of the śrāvakas or the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas?

Subhūti, whoever correctly discerns feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as merely what is imputed — merely superimposed and not truly real — and merely as confusion, that one does not apprehend consciousness as consciousness. Whoever does not apprehend consciousness as consciousness does not apprehend the view of consciousness as consciousness. Whoever does not apprehend the view of consciousness as consciousness does not apprehend everything in consciousness. Whoever

does not apprehend everything in consciousness does apprehend everything in consciousness. When one does not apprehend everything in consciousness yet does apprehend everything — that non-apprehension is thoroughly established. If one abides in that apprehension, one will find definitive liberation even through the Great Vehicle — what need is there to speak of the vehicle of the śrāvakas or the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas?

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva clings to form in accordance with the mere word — and engages with it at the level of conventional designation — that one habitually engages in the view of the transitory collection, habitually engages in craving for renewed existence, and habitually pursues destruction. This is a sign of not having fully understood form. Likewise, if a bodhisattva clings to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness in accordance with the mere word — and engages with them at the level of conventional designation — that one habitually engages in the view of the transitory collection, habitually engages in craving for renewed existence, and habitually pursues destruction. This is a sign of not having fully understood consciousness.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva clings to form in accordance with the mere word — and does not engage with it at the level of conventional designation, that one does not habitually engage in the view of the transitory collection, does not habitually engage in craving for renewed existence, and does not habitually pursue destruction. This is a sign of having fully understood form. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva clings to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness in accordance with the mere word — and does not engage with them at the level of conventional designation — that one does not habitually engage in the view of the transitory collection, does not habitually engage in craving for renewed existence, and does not habitually pursue destruction. This is a sign of having fully understood consciousness.

Subhūti, the three seeds of mind through the grasp of which conditions pertaining to form will lead to purification are these: the seed of mind that is aspiration, the seed of mind that is disenchantment, and the seed of mind that is non-dissipation. Subhūti, a bodhisattva must arouse these three minds with regard to form: the mind free from clinging, the mind of separation, and the mind of thorough purification.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva rightly follows and sees the arising of mind in relation to form, the non-arising, the great arising, and the simultaneous arising — if one thus rightly follows and sees in this way, one will swiftly and

manifestly fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening.

Subhūti, the three seeds of mind through the grasp of which conditions pertaining to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness will lead to purification are these: the seed of mind that is aspiration, the seed of mind that is disenchantment, and the seed of mind that is non-dissipation. Subhūti, a bodhisattva must arouse these three minds with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: the mind free from clinging, the mind of separation, and the mind of thorough purification. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva rightly follows and sees the arising of mind, the non-arising, the great arising, and the simultaneous arising with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness — and thus rightly follows and sees in this way — that one will swiftly and manifestly fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva rightly follows and sees form as existent, or likewise as existent or as non-existent, one should know that bodhisattva to be one who does not know suchness. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva rightly follows and sees feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as existent, or likewise as existent or as non-existent, one should know that bodhisattva to be one who does not know suchness.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva rightly follows and sees form as not existent, likewise as not existent, and as neither existent nor non-existent, that one is to be called a bodhisattva who knows suchness. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva rightly follows and sees feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as not existent, likewise as not existent, and as neither existent nor non-existent, that one is to be called a bodhisattva who knows suchness.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva, wishing to place the mind in meditative equipoise with regard to form, is devoted to form, and the mind moves, stirs, and ranges about in relation to form, one should know that bodhisattva to be one of inferior aspiration. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and

consciousness, wishing to place the mind in meditative equipoise yet being devoted to consciousness, if the mind moves, stirs, and ranges about in relation to consciousness, one should know that bodhisattva to be one of inferior aspiration.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva, wishing to place the mind in meditative equipoise with regard to form, is devoted to form with that mind, yet the mind does not

move, stir, or range about in relation to form, one should know that bodhisattva to be one of excellent aspiration. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva, wishing to place the mind in meditative equipoise with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, is devoted to consciousness with that mind, yet the mind does not move, stir, or range about in relation to consciousness, one should know that bodhisattva to be one of excellent aspiration.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva enters upon form in order to fully know phenomena as without characteristic, to fully pacify suffering, and to determine with certainty that nirvāṇa is the one thing, one should know that bodhisattva to have truly entered. A bodhisattva who has thus truly entered will swiftly realize and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva enters upon feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness in order to fully know phenomena as without characteristic, to fully pacify suffering, and to determine with certainty that nirvāṇa is the one thing, one should know that bodhisattva to have truly entered. A bodhisattva who has thus truly entered will swiftly realize and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

To fully know the signless,
to pacify suffering fully,
and to determine with certainty that peace is the one thing —
this is what the bodhisattva accomplishes.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva fully knows the phenomena of form as without appearance, as appearing throughout, as abiding therein, and as entering therein, just as they truly are, that bodhisattva will swiftly realize and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva fully knows the phenomena of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as without appearance, as appearing throughout, as abiding therein, and as entering therein, just as they truly are, that bodhisattva will swiftly realize and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Those phenomena that are without appearance
and yet are appearing throughout,
abiding therein and fully entering —
knowing these, one attains awakening.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva, upon thoroughly seeking form within form, does not apprehend it, and having made form non-apparent has fully realized the nature of reality of form, that bodhisattva will swiftly realize and fully awaken

to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva, upon thoroughly seeking consciousness within feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, does not apprehend it, and having made consciousness non-apparent has fully realized the nature of reality of consciousness, that bodhisattva will swiftly realize and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

The phenomenon that, when thoroughly sought, is not apprehended,
not appearing as a thing to the mind —
the wise one who rightly knows the nature of reality
will attain awakening.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who is skilled in the absence of substantial existence in form, possessing the dissolution of form and unmoving from the dharmadhātu of form, will swiftly realize and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Subhūti, a bodhisattva with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and

consciousness, a bodhisattva who is skilled in the absence of substantial existence in consciousness, possessing the dissolution of consciousness and unmoving from the dharmadhātu of consciousness, will swiftly realize and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

The wise one skilled in the absence of substantial existence,
possessing thorough dissolution,
unmoving from the dharmadhātu —
such a one will attain omniscience itself.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva thoroughly knows form as it truly is — as devoid of purpose, purposeless, and as great purpose — that bodhisattva will swiftly realize and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva thoroughly knows feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness as they truly are — as devoid of purpose, purposeless, and as great purpose — that bodhisattva will swiftly realize and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Knowing form as devoid of purpose, purposeless,
and in terms of great purpose —
bodhisattvas who know this
will attain great awakening.

Subhūti, the bodhisattva, the great being, with regard to form, having thoroughly known and fully abandoned these five kinds of attachment — the attachment of conceptual thought, the attachment of analytical thought, the attachment that is conceptual thought itself, attachment, great attachment, and the five attachments — should abandon them fully. Subhūti, the bodhisattva, the great being, with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, having thoroughly known and fully abandoned these five kinds of attachment — the attachment of conceptual thought, the attachment of analytical thought, the attachment that is conceptual thought itself, attachment, great attachment, and the five attachments — should abandon them fully.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva has fully abandoned these five attachments with regard to form, the intrinsic nature of form is not apprehended. Because the intrinsic nature of form is not apprehended, form is not apprehended as form in form. Because form is not apprehended as form in form, form is apprehended in form — and that very apprehending of form in form is the non-apprehension of form in form. That one who does not apprehend form, having thoroughly overpowered form in all its aspects, issues forth definitively into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva has fully abandoned these five attachments with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, the intrinsic nature of consciousness is not apprehended. Because the intrinsic nature of consciousness is not apprehended, consciousness is not apprehended in consciousness. Because consciousness is not apprehended as consciousness in consciousness, consciousness is not apprehended as consciousness in consciousness — and that very apprehending of consciousness as consciousness in consciousness is the non-apprehension of consciousness as consciousness in consciousness. That one who does not apprehend consciousness, having thoroughly overpowered consciousness in all its aspects, issues forth definitively into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva with regard to form, having thoroughly known and fully abandoned these five kinds of aversion — the aversion of conceptual thought and analytical inquiry, the aversion of explicit thought and analytical inquiry, the aversion of conceptual thought and analytical inquiry itself, aversion, great aversion, and the five aversions — should abandon them fully. Subhūti, a bodhisattva with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness,

having thoroughly known and fully abandoned these five kinds of aversion — the aversion of conceptual thought and analytical inquiry, the aversion of explicit thought and analytical inquiry, the aversion of conceptual thought and analytical inquiry itself, aversion, great aversion, and the five aversions — should abandon them fully.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva has fully abandoned these five aversions with regard to form, the intrinsic nature of form is not apprehended.

Because the intrinsic nature of form is not apprehended, form is not apprehended within form as form. Because form is not apprehended within form as form, form is apprehended within form as form. And that very apprehending of form within form as form is itself the non-apprehension of form within form as form. Through that — through neither apprehending nor not-apprehending form — having overpowered form in every aspect, one definitively emerges into unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva, having fully abandoned these five delusions with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, does not apprehend the intrinsic nature of consciousness. Because the intrinsic nature of consciousness is not apprehended, consciousness is not apprehended within consciousness as consciousness. Because consciousness is not apprehended within consciousness as consciousness, consciousness is apprehended within consciousness as consciousness. And that very apprehending of consciousness within consciousness as consciousness is itself the non-apprehension of consciousness within consciousness as consciousness. Through that — through neither apprehending nor not-apprehending consciousness — having overpowered consciousness in every aspect, one definitively emerges into unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly know and fully abandon these five delusions with regard to form: the delusion of error, the delusion that is the cause of error, the delusion that is the cause of non-error, delusion, great delusion — these five delusions should be fully abandoned. Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly know and fully abandon these five delusions with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: the delusion of error, the delusion that is the cause of error, the delusion that is the cause of non-error, delusion, and great delusion — these five delusions should be fully abandoned.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva has fully abandoned these five delusions with regard to form, the intrinsic nature of form is not apprehended. Because the intrinsic nature of form is not apprehended, form is not apprehended within form as form. Because form is not apprehended within form as form, form is apprehended within form as form. And that very apprehending of form within form as form is itself the non-apprehension of form within form as form. Through that — through neither apprehending nor not-apprehending form — having overpowered form in every aspect, one definitively emerges into unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva has fully abandoned these five delusions with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, the intrinsic nature of consciousness is not apprehended. Because the intrinsic nature of consciousness is not apprehended, consciousness is not apprehended within consciousness as consciousness. Because consciousness is not apprehended within consciousness as consciousness, consciousness is apprehended within consciousness as consciousness. And that very apprehending of consciousness within consciousness as consciousness is itself the non-apprehension of consciousness within consciousness as consciousness. Through that — through neither apprehending nor not-apprehending consciousness — having overpowered consciousness in every aspect, one definitively emerges into unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly know and fully abandon these five forms of conceit with regard to form: the conceit of extensive learning, the conceit of superiority, the conceit of manifest superiority, conceit, and great conceit — these five forms of conceit should be fully abandoned. Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly know and fully abandon these five forms of conceit with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: the conceit of extensive learning, the conceit of superiority, the conceit of manifest superiority, conceit, and great conceit — these five forms of conceit should be fully abandoned.

Subhūti, having fully abandoned these five forms of conceit with regard to form, a bodhisattva does not apprehend the intrinsic nature of form. Not apprehending the intrinsic nature of form, one does not apprehend form as form. Not apprehending form as form, one apprehends form in form — and that very apprehending of form in form is itself the non-apprehension of form as form. By that neither-apprehending-nor-non-apprehending of form, having utterly overwhelmed form in all its aspects, one definitively emerges into

unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Subhūti, having fully abandoned these five forms of conceit with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, a bodhisattva does not apprehend the intrinsic nature of consciousness. Not apprehending the intrinsic nature of consciousness, one does not apprehend consciousness as consciousness. Not apprehending consciousness as consciousness, one apprehends consciousness in consciousness — and that very apprehending of consciousness in consciousness is itself the non-apprehension of consciousness as consciousness. By that neither-apprehending-nor-non-apprehending of consciousness, having utterly overwhelmed consciousness in all its aspects, one definitively emerges into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly know and fully abandon these five views with regard to form in its intrinsic nature: the view of inversion, the view of existence, the view of denial, view, and great view — these five views should be fully abandoned. Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly know and fully abandon these five views with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness in their intrinsic nature: the view of inversion, the view of existence, the view of denial, view, and great view — these five views should be fully abandoned.

Subhūti, having fully abandoned these five views with regard to form, a bodhisattva does not apprehend the intrinsic nature of form. Not apprehending the intrinsic nature of form, one does not apprehend form as form. Not apprehending form as form, one apprehends form in form — and that very apprehending of form in form is itself the non-apprehension of form as form. By that neither-apprehending-nor-non-apprehending of form, having utterly overwhelmed form in all its aspects, one definitively emerges into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Subhūti, having fully abandoned these five views with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, a bodhisattva does not apprehend the intrinsic nature of consciousness. Not apprehending the intrinsic nature of consciousness, one does not apprehend consciousness as consciousness. Not apprehending consciousness as consciousness, one apprehends consciousness in consciousness — and that very apprehending of consciousness in consciousness is itself the non-apprehension of consciousness as consciousness. By that neither-apprehending-nor-non-apprehending of consciousness, having utterly overwhelmed consciousness in all its aspects, one definitively emerges into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly know and fully abandon these five forms of doubt with regard to form and phenomena, doubt with regard to beings, doubt with regard to suffering, doubt with regard to nirvāṇa, doubt with regard to buddhas and bodhisattvas, doubt, and great doubt — these five forms of doubt should be fully abandoned. Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly know and fully abandon these five forms of doubt with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: doubt with regard to phenomena, doubt with regard to beings, doubt with regard to suffering, doubt with regard to nirvāṇa, doubt with regard to buddhas and bodhisattvas, doubt, and

great doubt — these five forms of doubt should be fully known and fully abandoned. Subhūti, when a bodhisattva has fully abandoned these five forms of doubt with regard to form, that bodhisattva does not apprehend the intrinsic nature of form. Not apprehending the intrinsic nature of form, that bodhisattva does not apprehend form as form. And yet, not apprehending form as form, that bodhisattva does apprehend form as form — for the very act of apprehending form as form is itself the non-apprehension of form as form. Through that state of both apprehending and not apprehending form, having overwhelmed form in every respect, that bodhisattva thus emerges with certainty into unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. Subhūti, when a bodhisattva has fully abandoned these five forms of doubt with regard to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, that bodhisattva does not apprehend the intrinsic nature of consciousness. Not apprehending the intrinsic nature of consciousness, that bodhisattva does not apprehend consciousness as consciousness. And yet, not apprehending consciousness as consciousness, that bodhisattva does apprehend consciousness as consciousness — for the very act of apprehending consciousness as consciousness is itself the non-apprehension of consciousness as consciousness. Through that state of both apprehending and not apprehending consciousness, having overwhelmed consciousness in every respect, that bodhisattva thus emerges with certainty into unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who thoroughly seeks form and teaches the Dharma of form, who purifies the actions of body, speech, and mind with respect to form, and who seeks and teaches the Dharma in accordance with how form has been described, taught, and expounded — know that such a bodhisattva who purifies the actions of body, speech, and mind in that regard is one who seeks

out faults in form. Know that bodhisattva to be one whose talk is not of the true Dharma. Know that bodhisattva to have impure actions of body, speech, and mind with regard to form.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who thoroughly seeks form and teaches the Dharma of form, who purifies the actions of body, speech, and mind with respect to form, and who seeks and teaches the Dharma not in accordance with how form has been described, not in accordance with how it has been taught, and not in accordance with how it has been expounded — if that bodhisattva purifies the actions of body, speech, and mind in that regard, know that bodhisattva to be one who seeks what is excellent in form. Know that bodhisattva to be one whose talk is of right action of speech. Know that bodhisattva to have pure actions of body, speech, and mind with regard to form.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who thoroughly seeks feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness and teaches the Dharma of consciousness, who purifies the actions of body, speech, and mind with respect to consciousness, and who seeks and teaches the Dharma in accordance with how consciousness has been described, taught, and expounded — if that bodhisattva purifies the actions of body, speech, and mind in that regard, know that bodhisattva to be one who seeks out faults in consciousness. Know that bodhisattva to be one whose talk is not of the true Dharma. Know that bodhisattva to have impure actions of body, speech, and mind with regard to consciousness.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who thoroughly seeks consciousness and teaches the Dharma of consciousness, who purifies the actions of body, speech, and mind with respect to consciousness, and who seeks and teaches not in accordance with how consciousness has been described, not in accordance with how it has been taught,

not in accordance with how it has been described, and yet purifies the actions of body, speech, and mind in that regard — know that bodhisattva to be one who thoroughly seeks out consciousness, one whose talk is of the true Dharma, and know that bodhisattva to have pure actions of body, speech, and mind with respect to consciousness.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva wishes to place the mind in meditative equipoise on form, and that bodhisattva has inward devotional inclination toward form, two things come to be apprehended: the form that is the object of devotion, and the form that is the devotion itself. In that case, does that bodhisattva teach the devotional form in accordance with the object of devotion as it truly

is, or teach the devotion in accordance with the object of devotion as it truly is? Know that such a bodhisattva teaches form incorrectly. And why? Because the characteristic of devotional form is not to be found apart from the form that is the object of devotion. Subhūti, if the characteristic of devotional form were found apart from the form that is the object of devotion, then, with regard to the object of devotion, sentient beings with different devotions and those with different views would come to be apprehended as separate from one another; objects such as dreams and the like would also not come to be apprehended through objectless devotion; and ordinary childlike beings would come to see form as suchness itself, so that objectless, non-conceptual devotion would be established, and the form that is the object of devotion would not come to be entered into in accordance with reasoning.

But as things stand, Subhūti, sentient beings with different devotions do not come to be apprehended as separate from one another with regard to the object of devotion; objects such as dreams and the like do come to be apprehended through objectless devotion; and ordinary childlike beings do not come to see form as suchness itself. Rather, objectless, non-conceptual devotion is what becomes established, and the form that is the object of devotion is entered into in accordance with reasoning. Therefore a bodhisattva should regard the characteristic of the form that is the object of devotion as not being found apart from devotional form. Otherwise, that form that is the object of devotion — appearing just as it is, with its signs — would be fully arisen as a devotional form involving views that include signs. And that is why something else appears as the intended meaning.

A bodhisattva who sees in this way dismantles the perception of the form that is the object of devotion, thinking to themselves: if the form that is the object of devotion exists, then devotional form is reasonable; but if it does not exist, then it is not. Knowing this, that bodhisattva apprehends the mind that is confused regarding form, and in turn dismantles the perception of devotional form as well. Having thus shattered the perception of both forms, and having shattered all perceptions of form, one ceases to apprehend any form whatsoever. Through not apprehending any form, one apprehends confusion regarding form. Through apprehending confusion regarding form, one apprehends the cause of confusion regarding form. Through apprehending the cause of confusion regarding form, one fully accomplishes the Dharma of freedom from confusion regarding form. Through fully accomplishing the Dharma of freedom from confusion regarding form, one apprehends the cause

of freedom from confusion regarding form. Through apprehending the cause of freedom from confusion regarding form, one fully accomplishes the Dharma of freedom from confusion regarding form. Through fully accomplishing the Dharma of freedom from confusion regarding form, one fully accomplishes the Dharma concordant with the cause of freedom from confusion regarding form. And in this way one has from the very first fully accomplished both the Dharma of confusion regarding form and the Dharma of freedom from confusion regarding form.

Relying upon the Dharma of freedom from confusion regarding form and the Dharma concordant with the cause of freedom from confusion regarding form, one cultivates all the qualities of a buddha, brings sentient beings to complete maturation, thoroughly purifies buddha realms, and swiftly and fully realizes the unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening.

When a bodhisattva teaches form in this way, that teaching is the correct teaching.

Subhūti, when a bodhisattva wishes to place the mind in meditative equipoise with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, and is inwardly devoted to that consciousness, two objects will appear: the consciousness that is the object of devotion, and the consciousness that is the devotion itself.

Now, when a bodhisattva who is devoted to the consciousness of devotion shows the object of devotion exactly as it is, or shows the devotion to the object exactly as it is, one should recognize that bodhisattva as one who is teaching consciousness incorrectly. Why is that? Subhūti, apart from the consciousness that is the object of devotion, the defining characteristic of the consciousness of devotion does not exist elsewhere. Subhūti, if the defining characteristic of the consciousness of devotion did exist apart from the consciousness that is the object of devotion, then sentient beings with different kinds of devotion toward the object of devotion would be perceived as having different kinds of comparable views; the devotion that is without an object — such as the devotion found in dreams and the like — would not be perceived; ordinary childlike beings would be seen as perceiving the suchness of consciousness; and the consciousness that is the object of devotion would not be entered by devotion whose accomplishment is non-conceptual discernment.

Subhūti, since it is the case that sentient beings with different kinds of devotion toward the object of devotion are not seen as having different kinds of comparable views; since that devotion which is without an object — as in dreams and the like — is indeed perceived; since ordinary childlike beings do not perceive consciousness as suchness; and since the consciousness that is the object of devotion is indeed entered by devotion whose accomplishment is non-conceptual discernment — therefore a bodhisattva should understand that the defining characteristic of the consciousness of devotion does not exist apart from the consciousness that is the object of devotion. Otherwise, the consciousness that is the object of devotion would be nothing other than that consciousness of devotion properly arisen through a view laden with signs. And so a different meaning appears.

A bodhisattva who sees in this way dismantles the perception of the consciousness that is the object of devotion, thinking: "If the consciousness that is the object of devotion exists, then the consciousness of devotion is also fitting; but if it does not exist, then it is not." Recognizing this, one also dismantles the perception of the consciousness of devotion as being the consciousness of devotion. Having dismantled the perception of both these consciousnesses, one no longer perceives any consciousness whatsoever. Through not perceiving any consciousness whatsoever, one perceives confusion regarding consciousness. Through perceiving confusion regarding consciousness, one perceives the cause of confusion regarding consciousness. Through perceiving the cause of confusion regarding consciousness, one fully accomplishes the Dharma of freedom from confusion regarding consciousness. Through fully accomplishing the Dharma of freedom from confusion regarding consciousness, one fully accomplishes the Dharma concordant with the cause of freedom from confusion regarding consciousness. In this way one has from the very first fully accomplished both the Dharma of confusion regarding consciousness and the Dharma of freedom from confusion regarding consciousness.

Relying upon the Dharma of freedom from confusion regarding consciousness and the Dharma concordant with the cause of freedom from confusion regarding consciousness, one cultivates all the qualities of a buddha, brings sentient beings to complete maturation, thoroughly purifies buddha realms, and swiftly and fully realizes the unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening.

When a bodhisattva teaches consciousness in this way, that teaching is the correct teaching.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva's loving-kindness that accomplishes the supreme Dharma with respect to form, and loving-kindness that accomplishes worldly happiness with respect to form, and

loving-kindness that accomplishes transcendent happiness with respect to form, and loving-kindness, and great loving-kindness — these five aspects of loving-kindness are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should cultivate with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: loving-kindness that accomplishes the supreme Dharma, and loving-kindness that accomplishes worldly happiness, and loving-kindness that accomplishes transcendent happiness, and loving-kindness, and great loving-kindness — these five aspects of loving-kindness are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should cultivate with respect to form: compassion that does not gather sentient beings in, and compassion that gathers them in, and compassion that accompanies separation, and compassion, and great compassion — these five aspects of compassion are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should cultivate with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: compassion that does not gather sentient beings in, and compassion that gathers them in, and compassion that accompanies separation, and compassion, and great compassion — these five aspects of compassion are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should cultivate with respect to form: joy suffused with faith in the supreme Dharma, and joy that bestows benefit, and joy that rejoices in accord with it; and joy suffused with worldly happiness, and joy that bestows benefit, and joy that rejoices in accord with it; and joy suffused with transcendent happiness, and joy that bestows benefit, and joy that rejoices in accord with it; and joy, and great joy — these five aspects of joy are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should cultivate with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: joy suffused with faith in the supreme Dharma, and joy that bestows benefit, and joy that rejoices in accord with it; and joy suffused with worldly happiness, and joy that bestows benefit, and joy that rejoices in accord with it; and joy suffused with transcendent happiness, and joy that bestows benefit, and joy that rejoices in accord with it; and joy, and great joy — these five aspects of joy are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should cultivate with respect to form: equanimity that is free from wrong views and free from all afflictive defilement, the equanimity of taming that completely abandons all faults; and the equanimity of taming that is free from all afflictive defilement and that completely gathers all good qualities; and the equanimity of taming that is utterly free from all afflictive defilement; and equanimity, and great equanimity — these five aspects of equanimity are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should cultivate with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: equanimity free from wrong views and free from all afflictive defilement, the equanimity of taming that completely abandons all faults; and the equanimity of taming free from all afflictive defilement that completely gathers all good qualities; and the equanimity of taming that is utterly free from all afflictive defilement; and equanimity, and great equanimity — these five aspects of equanimity are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the perfection of generosity should cultivate with respect to form: pledged generosity, and generosity that accomplishes material gifts and fearlessness, and generosity that accomplishes the Dharma, and generosity, and great generosity — these five aspects of generosity are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the perfection of generosity should cultivate with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: pledged generosity, and generosity that accomplishes material gifts and fearlessness, and generosity that accomplishes the Dharma, and generosity, and great generosity — these five aspects of generosity are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the perfection of moral discipline should cultivate with respect to form: the moral discipline of the vow of proper undertaking with its prescribed signs, and the moral discipline of the vow of meditative concentration, and the moral discipline of the undefiled vow, and moral discipline, and great moral discipline —

these five aspects of moral discipline are to be cultivated. Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the perfection of moral discipline should cultivate with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: the moral discipline of the vow of proper undertaking with its prescribed signs, and the moral discipline of the vow of meditative concentration, and the moral discipline of the undefiled vow, and moral discipline, and great moral discipline — these five aspects of moral discipline are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the perfection of patience should cultivate with respect to form: patience that is equanimity toward sentient beings who do harm, and patience that accepts suffering, and patience that is firm conviction regarding the Dharma, and patience, and great patience — these five aspects of patience are to be cultivated. Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the perfection of patience should cultivate with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: patience that is equanimity toward sentient beings who do harm, and patience that accepts suffering, and patience that is firm conviction regarding the Dharma, and patience, and great patience — these five aspects of patience are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the perfection of diligence should cultivate with respect to form: diligence that takes up scripture and reflects on what is to be recited, and diligence that entirely abandons all faults, and diligence that entirely gathers all qualities, and diligence, and great diligence — these five aspects of diligence are to be cultivated. Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the perfection of diligence should cultivate with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: diligence that takes up scripture and reflects on what is to be recited, and diligence that entirely abandons all faults, and diligence that entirely gathers all qualities, and diligence, and great diligence — these five aspects of diligence are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the perfection of meditative concentration should cultivate with respect to form: the wholesome meditative concentration that relies on verbal formulation, and the worldly meditative concentration of virtue that is primordially pure and does not rely on verbal formulation, and the meditative concentration that transcends the world, and meditative concentration, and great meditative concentration — these five aspects of meditative concentration are to be cultivated. Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the perfection of meditative concentration should cultivate with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: the wholesome meditative concentration that relies on verbal formulation, and the worldly meditative concentration of virtue that is primordially pure and does not rely on verbal formulation, and the meditative concentration that transcends the world, and meditative concentration, and great meditative concentration — these five aspects of meditative concentration are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the Perfection of Wisdom should cultivate with respect to form: wisdom that relies on the meditative concentration that depends on verbal formulation, and wisdom that relies on the worldly meditative concentration of virtue that is primordially pure and does not rely on verbal formulation, and wisdom that relies on the meditative concentration that transcends the world, and wisdom, and great wisdom — these five aspects of wisdom are to be cultivated. Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in the Perfection of Wisdom should cultivate with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness: wisdom that relies on the meditative concentration that depends on verbal formulation, and wisdom that relies on the worldly meditative concentration of virtue that is primordially pure and does not rely on verbal formulation,

and wisdom that relies on the meditative concentration that transcends the world, and wisdom, and great wisdom — these five aspects of wisdom are to be cultivated.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who is endowed with reliance on a spiritual friend (kalyāṇamitra) should cultivate reliance on that spiritual friend with respect to form through these five aspects: reliance by way of listening, reliance by way of respectful service, reliance by way of thorough practice, reliance in accord with the rite of training, reliance by way of earnest delight, reliance, and great reliance — these five modes of relying on a spiritual friend. Subhūti, a bodhisattva who is endowed with reliance on a spiritual friend should cultivate reliance on that spiritual friend with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness through these five aspects: reliance by way of listening, reliance by way of respectful service, reliance by way of thorough practice, reliance in exact accord with the rite of training, reliance by way of earnest delight, reliance, and great reliance — these five modes of relying on a spiritual friend.

A bodhisattva who thus relies on a spiritual friend fully seizes upon the means of liberation, abundantly generates great merit, and swiftly comes to certainty of attaining unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in making offerings to the Tathāgata should make offerings to the Tathāgata with respect to form through these five aspects of offering: the offering that accomplishes manifold praise, the offering that accomplishes gain and honour, the offering that brings about earnest pleasure, offering, and great offering — these five kinds of offering.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva who strives in making offerings to the Tathāgata should make offerings to the Tathāgata with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness through these five aspects of offering: the offering that accomplishes manifold praise, the offering that accomplishes gain and honour, the offering that brings about earnest pleasure, offering, and great offering — these five kinds of offering.

The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, infinite throughout the buddha-fields of the ten directions, praise and extol a bodhisattva who thus strives in making offerings to the Tathāgata. From the world together with its gods, humans, and asuras such a one also receives gain and honour. One ripens immeasurable sentient beings, thoroughly purifies buddha-fields, and swiftly and manifestly attains unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva endowed with the Perfection of Generosity cultivates generosity with respect to form while holding to signs, one will not swiftly perfect the Perfection of Generosity. If one cultivates generosity without signs, one will swiftly perfect the Perfection of Generosity.

Subhūti, how does a bodhisattva cultivate generosity with respect to form either with signs or without signs? Subhūti, if a bodhisattva takes interest in generosity with respect to form, and apprehends generosity as something to take interest in or as the generosity of taking interest, then know that the bodhisattva is cultivating generosity with respect to form with signs.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva takes interest in generosity with respect to form in this way — recognising that form is unapprehensible by way of its essential nature, that in the same way things are unapprehensible as objects, and that by intrinsic nature they are unapprehensible — and thus does not apprehend the generosity that is to be aspired to nor the generosity of aspiration, then know that the bodhisattva is cultivating generosity with respect to form without signs.

Subhūti, if a bodhisattva striving in the perfection of generosity cultivates generosity with signs with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, then the perfection of generosity will not be swiftly brought to completion. If, however, one cultivates generosity without signs, then the perfection of generosity will be swiftly brought to completion.

Subhūti, how does a bodhisattva cultivate generosity with signs or without signs with respect to consciousness? Subhūti, if a bodhisattva takes interest in generosity with respect to consciousness, and apprehends either the

generosity that is to be aspired to or the generosity of aspiration, then know that the bodhisattva is cultivating generosity with signs with respect to consciousness. Subhūti, if a bodhisattva takes interest in generosity with respect to consciousness in this way — recognising that consciousness is unapprehensible by way of its essential nature, that in the same way things are unapprehensible as objects, and that by intrinsic nature they are unapprehensible — and thus does not apprehend the generosity that is to be aspired to nor the generosity of aspiration, then know that the bodhisattva is cultivating generosity without signs with respect to consciousness. The same is to be applied to moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption of emptiness with respect to form. Subhūti, what is the meditative absorption of emptiness with respect to form? Subhūti, that which focuses on form as the emptiness of being without an object, in the same way as the emptiness of being without things, and as the emptiness of intrinsic nature, and therein makes the mind one-pointed — this is the meditative absorption of emptiness. A bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption of emptiness with respect to form in just this way.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption of emptiness with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. Subhūti, what is the meditative absorption of emptiness with respect to consciousness? Subhūti, that which focuses on consciousness as the emptiness of being without an object, in the same way as the emptiness of being without things, and as the emptiness of intrinsic nature, and therein makes the mind one-pointed — this is the meditative absorption of emptiness. Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption of emptiness with respect to consciousness in just this way.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption without signs with respect to form. Subhūti, what is the meditative absorption without signs with respect to form? Subhūti, that in which a bodhisattva attends mentally to form as the emptiness of form being without an object, as the emptiness of being without things in the same way, and as the emptiness of intrinsic nature — whereby the sign of form as an object ceases, and the mind becomes free from the consciousness that follows after the sign of being without an object, free likewise from the consciousness that follows after the sign of an object, and free from the consciousness that follows after the signs

of both object and non-object — and therein makes the mind one-pointed: this, Subhūti, is the meditative absorption without signs with respect to form. A bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption without signs with respect to form in just this way.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption without signs with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. Subhūti, what is the meditative absorption without signs with respect to consciousness? Subhūti, that in which a bodhisattva attends mentally to consciousness as the emptiness of consciousness being without an object, as the emptiness of being without things in the same way, and as the emptiness of intrinsic nature — whereby the sign of consciousness as an object ceases,

and is freed also from consciousness that follows after the sign of thinglessness, and in just this way is freed from consciousness that follows after the sign of things, and is freed from consciousness that follows after the sign of both things and thinglessness, and the mind is made one-pointed — this, Subhūti, is the meditative absorption without signs with respect to consciousness. A bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption without signs with respect to consciousness in just this way.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption without aspiration with respect to form. Subhūti, what is the meditative absorption without aspiration with respect to form? That in which, through having attained the meditative absorption of emptiness and the meditative absorption without signs with respect to form, one makes the mind one-pointed upon an object discordant with the sign of thinglessness with respect to form, and in just this way upon an object discordant with the sign of thinglessness, and upon an object discordant with the sign of both things and thinglessness — this, Subhūti, is the meditative absorption without aspiration with respect to form. A bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption without aspiration with respect to form in just this way.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption without aspiration with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. Subhūti, what is the meditative absorption without aspiration with respect to consciousness? Subhūti, that in which, through having attained the meditative absorption of emptiness and the meditative absorption without signs with respect to consciousness, one makes the mind one-pointed upon an

object discordant with the sign of thinglessness with respect to consciousness, and in just this way upon an object discordant with the sign of things, and upon an object discordant with the sign of both things and thinglessness — this, Subhūti, is the meditative absorption without aspiration with respect to consciousness. A bodhisattva should thoroughly master the meditative absorption without aspiration with respect to consciousness in just this way.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master impermanence with respect to form through three meanings: the meaning of non-existence, the meaning of total disintegration, and the meanings of being with defilement and being without defilement. Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master impermanence with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness through three meanings: the meaning of non-existence, the meaning of total disintegration, and the meanings of being with defilement and being without defilement.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master suffering with respect to form through three meanings: the meaning of clinging, the meaning of the three kinds of characteristics, and the meaning of connection. Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master suffering with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness through three meanings: the meaning of clinging, the meaning of the three kinds of characteristics, and the meaning of connection.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master selflessness with respect to form through three meanings: the meaning of the selflessness of the absence of things, and in just this way the meaning of the selflessness of things, and the meaning of the selflessness of intrinsic nature. Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master selflessness with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness through three meanings: the meaning of the selflessness of the absence of things, and in just this way the meaning of the selflessness of things, and the meaning of the selflessness of intrinsic nature.

Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master with respect to form the meaning of the utter pacification of form as the absence of things, and in just this way the meaning of the pacification of things, and

the meaning of the utter pacification of form as purified by intrinsic nature; and through these three meanings one should thoroughly understand nirvāṇa as utter pacification. Subhūti, a bodhisattva should thoroughly master with respect to feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness the meaning of

the utter pacification of consciousness as the absence of things, and in just this way the meaning of the pacification of things, and the meaning of the utter pacification of consciousness as purified by intrinsic nature; and through these three meanings one should thoroughly understand nirvāṇa as utter pacification.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the elder Subhūti, the monks, the nuns, the laymen, the laywomen, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

The noble Perfection of Wisdom in Five Hundred Verses is complete.

Revised and definitively established through the new dialect.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered here as "without substance, of base substance, and yet of some substance" translates the triad གཞི་མེད་ཀྱི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་ཆོས་, which is technically and doctrinally challenging. The three terms map roughly onto: lacking inherent entity, having a defective or inferior entity, and having a conventional entity. This triad is distinctive to this particular Perfection of Wisdom text and does not have a straightforward parallel in other Prajñāpāramitā literature. The rendering adopted here reflects the most defensible reading, but scholars differ on the precise doctrinal import.

The phrase གསལ་བྱེད་ཀྱི་ཆོས་, rendered "illuminate it," could also mean "make it clear" or "elucidate it." In context it appears to denote a positive cognitive act that stands in contrast to clinging and affirming — namely, seeing the object clearly without superimposition.

- The phrase rendered "lord of creation" translates Tibetan dbang phyug, which corresponds to Sanskrit Īśvara, the theistic creator-deity. The text is presenting three classical wrong views about causation: karmic determinism, divine creationism, and acausalism, all of which the Buddha here rejects.

The final sentence presents a subtle doctrinal point: asserting the five aggregates merely by their conventional defining marks is classed as a wrong view associated with ordinary persons. The Tibetan adds "non-Buddhists and" before "childish ordinary persons" in this last instance, suggesting the error is even more fundamental than the preceding ones; this slight variation in the formula is preserved in the translation.

- The repeated phrase rendered "not of interpretable meaning, not of definitive meaning" translates a doubled construction in the Tibetan that is slightly unusual. The text says these teachings are "not interpretable-meaning, not of definitive-meaning" — which in context means the speaker wrongly insists the teachings on emptiness of the aggregates must be taken in their literal, surface sense and are neither requiring interpretation nor expressing a deeper intent. This is the opposite of the standard Mahāyāna hermeneutical position, which is why it is condemned as a wrong view.

The phrase "from the position of the non-Buddhists all the way to wrong view" reflects the Tibetan idiom listing a range of mistaken positions, from the non-Buddhist extreme through the ordinary-person extreme, culminating in wrong view proper.

- The passage turns on a deliberately paradoxical dialectical structure repeated for each

aggregate: apprehending "everything" in a given aggregate simultaneously entails not-apprehending "everything," and vice versa. The phrase rendered "thoroughly established" translates *yongs su grub pa*, which carries the technical Yogācāra sense of the *pariṇiṣpanna*, the thoroughly established nature — though in context it functions rhetorically to indicate a completed or perfected mode of cognition, whether mistaken or correct. The contrast between the two chains (the bodhisattva who mis-sees versus the one who correctly sees) maps onto liberation through lesser vehicles versus through the Great Vehicle, a distinction the text handles with care: correct conventional insight into the aggregates as "merely form" and "merely suffering" leads to śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha liberation, while the deeper insight developed in the subsequent section — seeing form as "merely imputed, merely confusion" — points toward the Mahāyāna path. The final paragraph's introduction of "merely imputed" and "merely confusion" signals a shift to an explicitly Yogācāra analysis of the imputed nature (*parikalpita*).

- The phrase rendered "the view of the transitory collection" translates *'jig tshogs la lta ba*, the standard Tibetan for *satkāyadrṣṭi*, the view that identifies a self with the five aggregates. The passage ends mid-sentence in the supplied Tibetan, mirroring the preceding passage's opening clause; the translation faithfully reflects this cutoff.

The repeated logical structure — apprehending everything entails not apprehending everything, and vice versa, with the residue being "thoroughly established" — reflects a Yogācāra dialectic distinguishing the imputed nature from the thoroughly established nature. The paradoxical formulations are preserved as the text presents them.

- The phrase rendered "seed of mind that is non-dissipation" translates མི་སྒྲིབ་པ་མེད་པའི་སྒྲིབ་པ་. The term མི་སྒྲིབ་པ་ is literally "not wasting away" or "not being consumed," pointing to the quality of not squandering or losing merit and resolve; "non-dissipation" captures this functional sense. The triad of aspiration, disenchantment, and non-dissipation as seeds of purification is a somewhat unusual formulation, and the precise doctrinal referent may vary across commentarial traditions.

The fourfold analysis of the arising of mind — arising, non-arising, great arising, and simultaneous arising — is a technical classification whose exact scholastic location is not immediately identifiable from the passage alone; no standard commentarial note is appended here as the translation reflects the plain sense faithfully.

- The fourfold set of "without appearance, appearing throughout, abiding therein, and entering therein" renders a technical formula whose exact doctrinal referent is not entirely transparent from the Tibetan alone; the translation renders the terms straightforwardly and consistently across both occurrences. The phrase "upon thoroughly seeking consciousness within feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness" reflects the Tibetan's slightly compressed syntax, which lists the four aggregates but then specifies only consciousness as the object of seeking; this appears to be an abbreviated parallel to the preceding form passage rather than a textual error.

- The fivefold taxonomy of attachment and aversion is highly technical and its precise doctrinal delineation in this sūtra is unusual. The Tibetan lists five distinct terms for attachment: conceptual attachment, elaborated attachment, a third form of conceptual attachment, plain attachment, and great attachment — suggesting a graduated scheme of increasing subtlety or intensity. The passage on "form apprehended in form" and "non-apprehension as apprehension" uses deliberate paradox to convey the non-dual insight beyond subject-object fixation; the translation preserves the paradox faithfully rather than smoothing it over.

The phrase rendered "devoid of purpose, purposeless, and as great purpose" reflects the threefold analysis of *artha* in the Tibetan: *don dang bral ba*, *don med pa*, and *don chen po*. This

triad does not map straightforwardly onto standard scholastic categories and may represent a specific doctrinal scheme of this text rather than a widely attested formula.

- The paradoxical formulation "because X is not apprehended, X is apprehended; and that very apprehending is the non-apprehension" is reproduced faithfully as it stands in the Tibetan. This is a deliberate dialectical structure characteristic of certain Perfection of Wisdom literature, not a scribal error.

The five delusions listed here — delusion of error, delusion that is the cause of error, delusion that is the cause of non-error, delusion, and great delusion — parallel the five aversions of the preceding passage, suggesting a systematic enumeration of mental afflictions across their structural variants. The precise technical meaning of each subtype is not further defined in this passage.

- The repeated dialectical formula — not apprehending the intrinsic nature, therefore not apprehending X as X, therefore apprehending X in X, which is itself non-apprehension — is a deliberate and precise philosophical paradox preserved faithfully. It expresses the Prajñāpāramitā logic that true non-conceptual cognition transcends the opposition of apprehension and non-apprehension.

The five views listed are rendered as: the view of inversion (phyin ci log gi Ita ba), the view of existence (yod do snyam pa'i Ita ba), the view of denial or denigration (skur pa 'debs pa'i Ita ba), view (Ita ba), and great view (Ita ba chen po). These parallel the five conceits and five doubts as enumerated sets specific to this sūtra context.

The text ends mid-sentence, as the passage was cut at that point.

- The central paradox of apprehension and non-apprehension rendered in this passage reflects a standard Perfection of Wisdom dialectic: genuine meditative apprehension of a phenomenon entails the simultaneous non-fixation on it as an inherently existent object. The phrase "overwhelmed in every respect" renders the Tibetan idiom for total transcendence or surpassing of the aggregate in question. The contrast between teaching "in accordance with" and "not in accordance with" how something has been described is subtle: the former indicates a reifying, conceptually elaborating approach that looks for faults, while the latter indicates teaching that does not reify and thus purifies conduct — this is a recognized doctrinal point in Perfection of Wisdom literature and has been rendered accordingly.

- The passage hinges on a distinction between "the form that is the object of devotion" and "devotional form" — that is, the object as it presents itself to aspiration or inclination, and the mental form that is the act or content of that devotion. The argument that the characteristic of devotional form is not separable from its object is a classically Yogācāra move: if the two were genuinely separate, a series of absurd consequences would follow, including that dreams could not be apprehended through objectless devotion and that non-conceptual realization would be available to ordinary beings without reasoning. The Tibetan term translated throughout as "devotion" or "devotional inclination" is *mos pa*, which here has the technical sense of aspiration, inclination, or the mental act of taking something as one's object of interest — not merely devotion in a devotional-practice sense.

- The passage presents a sustained and technically intricate argument about the relationship between the "consciousness that is the object of devotion" and the "consciousness of devotion itself." The Tibetan term "*mospai nām par shes pa*" and "*mospar byaba'i nām par shes pa*" create a paired technical distinction — roughly, the consciousness-of-aspiration or -devotion as subject versus the consciousness as its object — which is difficult to render with full elegance in English. The renderings chosen here follow the structural logic of the argument: that the character of the subjective devotion-consciousness cannot be found outside of or apart from the object-consciousness toward which it is directed, which is a Yogācāra-style analysis of the

inseparability of the cognitive act from its referent.

The final sentence of the translated passage is incomplete in the source text as given, ending mid-enumeration, and so the translation likewise ends there.

- The three types of compassion distinguished here, literally "not-gathering compassion," "gathering compassion," and "separation compassion," are a somewhat unusual threefold schema. They likely refer to: compassion toward beings not yet drawn to one's care, compassion actively drawing beings in, and compassion as one parts from or releases them. This schema is not standard in the most common Mahāyāna doctrinal lists, and the precise nuance of each category may warrant consultation of an available commentary on this sūtra.

The term translated as "pledged generosity" renders a phrase meaning generosity accompanied by a vow or commitment. The compound for "material gifts and fearlessness" groups together two of the classical three kinds of giving: gifts of material things and gifts of fearlessness, with the Dharma gift being the third, here listed separately.

- The phrase rendered "takes up scripture and reflects on what is to be recited" translates the Tibetan for receiving oral transmission and applying oneself to recitation, two related aspects of scriptural study that constitute the first type of diligence listed. The distinction between the two types of meditative concentration — one relying on verbal formulation and one that is "primordially pure" and independent of it — reflects a standard Abhidharma and Prajñāpāramitā distinction between conceptually supported and non-conceptually supported absorption, further divided into mundane and supramundane levels.

- The fivefold taxonomy of "reliance on a spiritual friend" is rendered somewhat expansively because the Tibetan uses a serial enumeration in which the same term "reliance" appears in different grammatical positions, signalling a progression from simple to "great" reliance with intermediate qualifications. The five are: listening-based reliance, respectful service, thorough practice, accordance with the rite of training, and earnest delight — with "reliance" and "great reliance" as the culminating pair. This pattern mirrors the preceding fivefold wisdom series.

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation faithfully breaks off at the same point. The threefold emptiness formula — emptiness of the absence of an object, emptiness of the absence of things, and emptiness of intrinsic nature — is rendered consistently with its previous occurrences. The subtle distinction in the signless absorption section between consciousness following the sign of non-existence, following the sign of existence, and following the sign of both is a technical doctrinal point; the translation preserves the triple structure as given in the Tibetan.

- The three-meaning analysis of impermanence listed as "non-existence, total disintegration, and with defilement and without defilement" is somewhat unusual in standard Abhidharma enumeration. The Tibetan is clear but the underlying doctrinal schema may reflect a specific sūtra-level taxonomic tradition rather than the more common four or five aspects; no emendation has been made.

The section on the meditative absorption without aspiration describes attending to objects "discordant with" (mi 'thun pa) the signs of things and thinglessness. This is a technically specific term meaning that the object of focus is one that runs counter to, or is incompatible with, those signs — rendering it as "discordant with" preserves that technical sense.

- The closing colophon line reads literally "revised and definitively established through the new dialect," a standard Tibetan canon scribal note indicating a later editorial revision of the translation according to the standardized New Translation orthographic conventions. It is not part of the sūtra proper.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.